

Listening Transcript Set 2 Passage 9

W: Hi, Natan! I've never met anybody from Malta before.

M: Unsurprising. There are only about half a million of us!

W: Really? Wow! Well, it looks beautiful. I'd love to visit.

M: You should! The sea's always nearby, the weather's warm, and the food... Well, if I could pack one thing in my suitcase, it'd be the food!

W: Is there much sightseeing?

M: Yes! Beautiful palaces and ancient military watchtowers. Plus, Valletta, the capital, is a UNESCO World Heritage Site. The whole city!

W: Wow! Are there any downsides?

M: Well, Malta has always struggled with its water supply. We have no natural lakes or rivers, and it's raining less due to climate change. There's only enough groundwater to meet 65% of our needs.

W: Is the rest imported in?

M: No, we make it by cleaning seawater so it's safe to drink. But a single oil spill could ruin the entire water supply.

W: Sounds worrying.

M: The government is working to reduce water losses in the system. But the real issue is that people need to stop wasting water.

W: That's true for everyone!